

KEY TOPIC 3 COURSE TEXTBOOK • CHRONOLOGICAL ENQUIRY SEQUENCE • 1974–1995**THE SEARCH FOR PEACE***From Shuttle Diplomacy and Camp David to Lebanon, the Intifada, and the Oslo Accords***ARCHIVAL PRIMARY RECORD • 13 SEPTEMBER 1993****WHITE-HOUSE / ACC-1993-09-13****The Historic Handshake: Yitzhak Rabin and Yasser Arafat, White House Lawn**

Israeli Prime Minister Yitzhak Rabin and PLO Chairman Yasser Arafat shake hands following the signing of the Oslo Declaration of Principles, hosted by US President Bill Clinton.

ARCHIVAL PRIMARY RECORD

EDEXCEL PAPER 2 MASTER ARCHIVE

PEARSON EDEXCEL GCSE (9–1) HISTORY SPECIFICATION CONTENT**KEY TOPIC 3 COVERAGE****3.1 DIPLOMACY & CAMP DAVID, 1974–79**

- **Oil crisis fallout:** Western stagflation forces US intervention in Middle East diplomacy.
- **Kissinger's shuttle diplomacy:** Sinai I (1974), Syrian disengagement & Sinai II (1975).
- **Reopening of Suez Canal (1975) & election of Likud's Menachem Begin (1977).**
- **Sadat's Jerusalem visit (Nov 1977):** Address to Israeli Knesset breaking psychological barrier.
- **Camp David Accords (1978) & 1979 Washington Peace Treaty:** Sinai returned to Egypt.

CAUSAL CHAIN OF EVENTS**CHRONOLOGY**

- 1974–75** Kissinger's Shuttle Diplomacy
↓
May 1977 Likud Victory: Menachem Begin PM
↓
Nov 1977 Sadat Addresses Israeli Knesset
↓
Sep 1978 Carter Brokers Camp David Accords
↓
Mar 1979 Washington Treaty: Sinai Returned

3.2 THE PALESTINIAN ISSUE, 1974–93

- **PLO international recognition:** Rabat Summit & Arafat's 1974 UN address ('olive branch').
- **Operation Peace for Galilee (1982):** Israeli invasion of Lebanon; Siege of Beirut.
- **Sabra and Shatila massacres (Sep 1982):** Phalangist militias & Kahan Commission report.
- **First Intifada (1987–93):** Civil disobedience in Gaza & West Bank vs IDF 'Iron Fist'.
- **Rise of Hamas (1987):** Islamic Resistance Movement challenges secular PLO.

CAUSAL CHAIN OF EVENTS**CHRONOLOGY**

- Nov 1974** Arafat UN Address ('Olive Branch')
↓
Oct 1981 Sadat Assassinated in Cairo
↓
Jun 1982 Operation Peace for Galilee: Lebanon
↓
Sep 1982 Sabra & Shatila Refugee Massacres
↓
Dec 1987 First Intifada Erupts (Gaza & West Bank)

3.3 ATTEMPTS AT A SOLUTION, 1988–95

- **Arafat's diplomatic pivot (1988):** Renounces terrorism & recognises Israel in Geneva.
- **Fall of Soviet Union & Gulf War (1991): Madrid Peace Conference.**
- **Oslo I Accords (1993):** Secret Norwegian channel; historic White House handshake.
- **Palestinian Authority created:** Limited self-rule in Gaza and Jericho; IDF withdrawal.
- **Oslo II (1995) Areas A, B, C;** extremist opposition; **assassination of Rabin** (Nov 1995).

CAUSAL CHAIN OF EVENTS**CHRONOLOGY**

- Oct 1991** Madrid Peace Conference Convenes
↓
Jun 1992 Rabin & Labor Win Election
↓
13 Sep 93 Oslo I White House Handshake
↓
Sep 1995 Oslo II: West Bank Enclaves (A, B, C)
↓
4 Nov 95 Yitzhak Rabin Assassinated in Tel Aviv

KEY TOPIC 3.1 SUPERPOWER DIPLOMACY • 1974–1978

Diplomatic Negotiations: Shuttle Diplomacy to Jerusalem

Pearson Specification Focus: The oil crisis and superpower involvement: the roles of the USA (Kissinger's shuttle diplomacy) and the USSR; the 1974–75 disengagement accords; the reopening of the Suez Canal; the 1977 Israeli election of Menachem Begin; Sadat's visit to Israel (November 1977) and Knesset speech.

The 1973 Oil Shock & Superpower Roles

[1.1] The October 1973 Yom Kippur War fundamentally transformed global geopolitics. For the first time, Arab members of **OPEC** successfully wielded the 'oil weapon,' cutting crude oil production and placing an embargo on Western nations supporting Israel. Crude oil prices quadrupled from \$3 to \$12 per barrel, triggering crippling inflation, industrial stagnation, and fuel rationing across Western Europe and the United States.

[1.2] The economic shock forced the United States to reassess its Middle Eastern strategy. Washington could no longer afford an unstable status quo in which regional flare-ups threatened the global economy and brought the US and Soviet Union to the brink of nuclear confrontation. US Secretary of State **Henry Kissinger** recognized that the psychological breakthrough of the 1973 war—which restored Arab self-respect while shattering Israel's belief in its permanent military invulnerability—created an unprecedented window for negotiated diplomacy.

Henry Kissinger's "Shuttle Diplomacy" (1974–1975)

[1.3] Because Arab states still refused to sit in direct face-to-face negotiations with Israel, Kissinger pioneered **shuttle diplomacy**. Traveling relentlessly on his Air Force Boeing 707 between Jerusalem, Cairo, and Damascus, Kissinger acted as an intermediary, carrying draft proposals, personal assurances, and American aid packages.

[1.4] Kissinger's strategy yielded concrete breakthroughs. In January 1974, Egypt and Israel signed the **Sinai I Disengagement Accord**, pulling Israeli troops back from the canal and creating a UN-monitored buffer zone. In May 1974, Kissinger brokered a parallel Syrian-Israeli disengagement on the Golan Heights. In September 1975, the **Sinai II Accord** saw Israel withdraw further to the strategic Gidi and Mitla Passes, returning the Abu Rudeis oilfields to Egypt. In exchange, Egypt pledged non-belligerency, allowed non-military Israeli cargoes through the canal, and on 5 June 1975, officially reopened the **Suez Canal** to international commerce after eight years of closure.

KEY INDIVIDUAL1923–2023



Henry Kissinger
US SECRETARY OF STATE (1973–1977)
Pioneered 'shuttle diplomacy' between Jerusalem, Cairo, and Damascus. Brokered the 1974 & 1975 Sinai Disengagement Accords, decoupling Egypt from Moscow and realigning Middle Eastern diplomacy firmly toward Washington.

SOURCE A DIPLOMATIC MAP1974–1975

The Sinai Disengagement Accords (Sinai I & II)



Kissinger's phased disengagement treaties established a UN buffer zone east of the Suez Canal, allowing Egypt to clear and reopen the vital maritime waterway in June 1975.

US State Department Historical OfficeSinai Disengagement Records, 1975

SOURCE B ARCHIVAL PHOTOGRAPH13 November 1974

Yasser Arafat Addresses the UN General Assembly in New York



Invited to address the UN General Assembly following the Arab League's recognition of the PLO at the Rabat Summit, Chairman Yasser Arafat declared: "I have come bearing an olive branch and a freedom fighter's gun. Do not let the olive branch fall from my hand."

United Nations Audiovisual LibraryGeneral Assembly Plenary Meeting 2282, 13 November 1974

KEY SPECIFICATION TERMINOLOGY & CONCEPTS			DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY
Shuttle Diplomacy: Negotiation technique created by Henry Kissinger, flying between Middle Eastern	Sinai II Accord (1975): Bilateral accord restoring Egyptian civilian control over Abu Rudeis oilfields and	Knesset Speech (1977): President Anwar Sadat's historic journey to Jerusalem, addressing the Israeli parliament	

The 1977 Likud Victory & Menachem Begin

[1.5] In May 1977, Israeli politics underwent an earthquake. For 29 years since 1948, the moderate, secular Labour Party had governed Israel uninterrupted. In the wake of public anger over the military unpreparedness in 1973, the right-wing **Likud Party** won the national election.

[1.6] The new Prime Minister was **Menachem Begin**, former commander of the underground Irgun militia. Begin was a committed ideological Revisionist Zionist who believed in 'Greater Israel' (*Eretz Yisrael*) and viewed the West Bank and Gaza as biblical Judea and Samaria, lands that could never be surrendered. However, regarding the Sinai Desert—which held no biblical sanctity—Begin was pragmatically willing to consider territorial compromise if it secured permanent peace with Egypt and detached Israel's most formidable Arab adversary from the conflict.

ARCHIVAL DISPATCHLIVE BROADCAST14 November 1977

Walter Cronkite's Live Television Summit

In a historic split-screen broadcast on CBS News, Walter Cronkite asked Sadat if he would truly travel to Jerusalem. When Sadat affirmed he would go immediately upon receiving an official invitation, Cronkite switched live to Begin in Jerusalem, who responded on air: "Any time, any day, he will be received cordially and with the respect due to a President." The diplomatic bluff was called on live television.

CBS Evening News ArchiveBroadcast Record, 14 November 1977

Sadat's Historic Gamble: Speech to the Knesset (1977)

[1.7] In Egypt, President **Anwar Sadat** faced severe domestic crises. In January 1977, deadly 'Bread Riots' erupted across Cairo after IMF-mandated subsidy cuts, threatening his regime. Sadat realized Egypt could no longer sustain a ruinous war economy spending over 30% of its GDP on the military. Frustrated by sluggish multilateral diplomacy in Geneva, Sadat took a breathtaking geopolitical gamble.

[1.8] On 9 November 1977, Sadat announced to the Egyptian Parliament that he was prepared to go "to the ends of the earth—even to the Israeli Knesset" to discuss peace. Begin immediately issued a formal invitation. On 19 November 1977, Sadat's presidential aircraft landed at Ben-Gurion Airport, where he was greeted with full state honours by Begin and Golda Meir. The following day, Sadat addressed the Knesset in Jerusalem. While reaffirming that peace required total Israeli withdrawal from Arab lands captured in 1967 and the realization of Palestinian rights, Sadat declared unequivocally: *"No more war, no more bloodshed."* In a single stroke, the psychological barrier of hatred that had paralyzed Arab-Israeli relations for three decades was shattered.

SOURCE C OFFICIAL SPEECH20 November 1977

President Anwar Sadat Addresses the Israeli Knesset

"I have not come to you to seek a separate peace between Egypt and Israel... I have come to you so that together we might build a durable peace based on justice... In the name of God, I tell you that we welcome you among us with full security and peace. No more war, no more bloodshed."

Knesset Parliamentary Record / Arab Republic of EgyptJerusalem Address, 20 November 1977

KEY FIGURE1918–1981



Anwar Sadat
PRESIDENT OF EGYPT (1970–1981)

Bold strategist who launched the 1973 crossing to break diplomatic deadlock, then took the historic risk to visit Jerusalem and sign peace with Israel.

STRATEGIC DECISIONS & ACTIONS:

- Broke Diplomatic Deadlock:** Addressed the Israeli Knesset in November 1977, dismantling 30 years of Arab psychological rejectionism.
- Camp David Accords (1978):** Negotiated the phased return of the entire Sinai Peninsula and oilfields to Egyptian sovereignty.
- Paid with His Life:** Assassinated on 6 October 1981 by Islamic Jihad militants in Cairo for signing a separate bilateral peace.

HISTORICAL CONTEXTDOMESTIC PRESSURES

The 1977 Cairo Bread Riots & The Economic Drive for Peace

In January 1977, violent riots swept Cairo when Sadat cut basic food subsidies to satisfy IMF lenders. With 30% of Egypt's budget devoured by military readiness and Soviet debt crushing the treasury, Sadat recognized that Egypt faced domestic economic collapse. Economic necessity—not ideological affection for Israel—drove his breathtaking gamble to fly to Jerusalem.

Exam Insight: Explains why Sadat broke Arab League unity: domestic economic desperation forced a swift bilateral exit from war.

KEY TOPIC 3.2 HISTORIC ACCORDS • 1978–1982

The Camp David Accords & The Treaty of Washington

Pearson Specification Focus: The Camp David Summit (September 1978) and the role of Jimmy Carter; the two Frameworks for Peace; the Egypt-Israel Peace Treaty of Washington (March 1979); the Israeli withdrawal from Sinai; and the Arab backlash, expulsion of Egypt, and assassination of Sadat (1981).

The Camp David Summit (September 1978)

[2.1] Following Sadat's visit to Jerusalem, direct negotiations quickly deadlocked over Israeli settlements in Sinai and the future of the West Bank. Sensing an impending diplomatic collapse, newly elected US President **Jimmy Carter** intervened decisively. In September 1978, Carter invited Sadat and Begin to the secluded presidential retreat at **Camp David** in the Catoctin Mountains of Maryland.

[2.2] For thirteen grueling days, Carter engaged in marathon mediation. Mutual antipathy between Begin and Sadat was so intense that after three days they refused to speak to each other; Carter was forced to walk back and forth between their cabins carrying handwritten revisions. Begin refused to dismantle Jewish settlements in Sinai or grant sovereignty to the West Bank, while Sadat insisted on total Israeli withdrawal and Palestinian self-determination. Through relentless personal diplomacy, threats to withhold US military subsidies, and appeal to their shared monotheistic values, Carter forged a breakthrough on 17 September 1978.

SOURCE A ARCHIVAL PHOTOGRAPH

September 1978

Begin, Carter, and Sadat at the Camp David Summit



Jimmy Carter's thirteen-day marathon mediation at Camp David produced the historic 'Framework for Peace in the Middle East' between Menachem Begin and Anwar Sadat.

White House Historical Collection

Camp David, Maryland, 17 September 1978

The Two Frameworks for Peace

[2.3] The Camp David agreement comprised two distinct frameworks:

[2.4] 1. Framework for the Conclusion of a Peace Treaty between Egypt and Israel: Israel agreed to completely evacuate the Sinai Peninsula in phases over three years, dismantling eighteen Israeli settlements (including the town of Yamit) and returning the oilfields. In return, Egypt agreed to establish full diplomatic relations, exchange ambassadors, open normal trade, and demilitarize the Sinai with international peacekeeping observers.

[2.5] 2. Framework for Peace in the Middle East: Envisioned a five-year transitional period for the West Bank and Gaza Strip, during which Israeli military administration would be replaced by a self-governing Palestinian authority. However, this framework was left deliberately vague: Begin insisted 'autonomy' applied only to the people, not the land, and fiercely rejected any independent Palestinian state.

SOURCE B PRIMARY DIPLOMATIC ACCORD

17 September 1978

Extract from the Camp David Framework for Peace

"Egypt and Israel agree that, in order to ensure peace in the area, a negotiated settlement between Israel and any of its neighbors who have not yet done so is essential... The parties agree that the basis for a peaceful settlement of the conflict is UN Security Council Resolution 242 in all its parts. A peace treaty between Israel and Egypt will be signed within three months, providing for the full exercise of Egyptian sovereignty up to the internationally recognized border between Egypt and mandated Palestine, and the complete withdrawal from the Sinai of Israeli armed forces."

White House Archival Record

Camp David Framework for Peace, Document No. 841

KEY SPECIFICATION TERMINOLOGY & CONCEPTS

DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

Camp David Accords:

Thirteen-day trilateral summit hosted by Jimmy Carter (1978), creating frameworks for bilateral peace and Palestinian autonomy.

Treaty of Washington:

Formal 1979 peace treaty: Egypt recognized Israel; Israel evacuated the entire Sinai Peninsula and returned it to Egypt by 1982.

Arab League Boycott:

The diplomatic expulsion and economic boycott of Egypt by Arab nations in outrage over concluding a separate peace with Israel.

The 1979 Washington Treaty & Sinai Withdrawal

[2.6] On 26 March 1979, on the North Lawn of the White House, Sadat and Begin formally signed the **Treaty of Peace between Egypt and Israel**. The treaty ended 31 years of official state of war. Under the agreement, Israel completed its phased evacuation of Sinai by April 1982, returning the oilfields and strategic mountain passes.

[2.7] The treaty was a profound strategic triumph for Israel. By neutralizing Egypt—the most populous Arab country and the only army capable of leading a multi-front assault—Israel eliminated the existential threat of a coordinated conventional invasion. The United States guaranteed the pact by granting massive annual military subsidies: approximately \$3 billion to Israel and \$2 billion to Egypt annually.

[2.8] The Yamit Resistance & Sinai Evacuation (April 1982): The surrender of northern Sinai provoked intense domestic trauma within Israel. Ultra-nationalist religious settlers belonging to Gush Emunim barricaded themselves on rooftops and inside bunkers in the Mediterranean coastal town of Yamit, threatening mass suicide. Defence Minister Ariel Sharon deployed thousands of unarmed IDF soldiers to forcibly tear settlers away from their homes, before deploying military bulldozers to level Yamit's houses, schools, and civic buildings into the sand dunes to ensure settlers could never return.

SOURCE C ARCHIVAL PHOTOGRAPH

26 March 1979

Signing the Egypt-Israel Peace Treaty in Washington



Sadat, Carter, and Begin join hands on the North Lawn of the White House, formalizing the first peace treaty between the State of Israel and an Arab sovereign nation.

US National Archives (NARA)

Washington, D.C., 26 March 1979

Arab Fury, Boycott & The Assassination of Sadat

[2.9] Across the Arab world, the treaty provoked explosive fury. Arab states condemned Sadat as a traitor who had broken the Khartoum 'Three Noes,' abandoned the Palestinians, and sold out Arab solidarity for a separate bilateral deal. The Arab League immediately suspended Egypt's membership, severed diplomatic relations, moved its headquarters from Cairo to Tunis, and imposed a strict economic boycott.

[2.10] Within Egypt, domestic opposition surged among leftists, Arab nationalists, and Islamist groups. On 6 October 1981, during a military parade celebrating the eighth anniversary of the 1973 Suez crossing, radical Egyptian Islamic Jihad soldiers leaped from a military truck and opened fire on the reviewing stand with automatic rifles and grenades. Sadat was assassinated instantly. His successor, **Hosni Mubarak**, honored the treaty with Israel while maintaining a 'cold peace,' re-establishing Egypt's ties with the Arab world.

KEY FIGURE

1913–1992



Menachem Begin

PRIME MINISTER OF ISRAEL (1977–1983)

Likud leader who made peace with Egypt at Camp David while accelerating Jewish settlement expansion across the West Bank and Gaza.

STRATEGIC DECISIONS & ACTIONS:

- **Surrendered Sinai for Peace:** Evacuated the entire Sinai Peninsula and dismantled Jewish settlements to eliminate Egypt from the Arab war coalition.
- **Shared 1978 Nobel Peace Prize:** Awarded the Nobel Peace Prize alongside Anwar Sadat for the historic Camp David breakthrough.
- **Annexed Jerusalem & Invaded Lebanon:** Passed the 1980 Jerusalem Law declaring unified Jerusalem Israel's eternal capital, and launched the 1982 invasion of Lebanon.

HISTORICAL MECHANISM

DIPLOMATIC REALITIES

The Reality of the 'Cold Peace': Why Normalisation Stalled

While the 1979 treaty eliminated conventional warfare between armies and established official embassies, true social and cultural reconciliation never developed. Egyptian professional syndicates (lawyers, doctors, engineers) expelled members who visited Israel, tourism was one-way, and popular anger erupted following Israel's 1982 invasion of Lebanon. The treaty created peace between states, but not peace between peoples.

Key Historical Distinction: Distinguish strategic military non-belligerency (the treaty) from grassroots cultural normalization ('cold peace').

KEY ENQUIRY CHECK • CAMP DAVID & THE TREATY OF WASHINGTON

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. TWO FRAMEWORKS:

Explain the difference between the bilateral Egypt-Israel treaty framework and the broader Middle East framework agreed at Camp David.

2. ARAB BACKLASH:

Why did the Arab League sever diplomatic ties with Egypt and expel it following the signing of the 1979 Treaty of Washington?

3. EVALUATIVE HINGE:

Did the Camp David Accords bring lasting peace to the Middle East, or did they merely neutralize Egypt and isolate the Palestinians?

KEY TOPIC 3.3 LEBANON & MASSACRE • 1974–1985

The Palestinian Issue: Lebanon & Sabra and Shatila

Pearson Specification Focus: The Palestinian problem in Lebanon; the creation of 'Fatahland'; Operation Litani (1978); Operation Peace for Galilee (June 1982); the siege of West Beirut and PLO evacuation; the Sabra and Shatila massacres (September 1982); and the Kahan Commission report.

The Rise of "Fatahland" in Southern Lebanon

[3.1] Following its violent expulsion from Jordan during Black September (1970), Yasser Arafat relocated the **Palestine Liberation Organization (PLO)** headquarters and 15,000 armed fighters to Lebanon. Exploiting Lebanon's fragile sectarian system and the outbreak of the **Lebanese Civil War (1975)**, the PLO established a de facto state-within-a-state across southern Lebanon, which Israelis dubbed '**Fatahland**.'

[3.2] From southern Lebanon, Palestinian fedayeen launched cross-border rocket barrages and commando raids into northern Israeli towns. In March 1978, Fatah militants landed on the Israeli coast, hijacked an intercity bus on the Coastal Highway, and killed 38 Israeli civilians (including 13 children). Israel retaliated with **Operation Litani**, invading southern Lebanon with 25,000 troops. The UN deployed a peacekeeping force (**UNIFIL**) along the border, but PLO rocket attacks against Israeli settlements in Galilee continued.

Operation Peace for Galilee & The Siege of Beirut

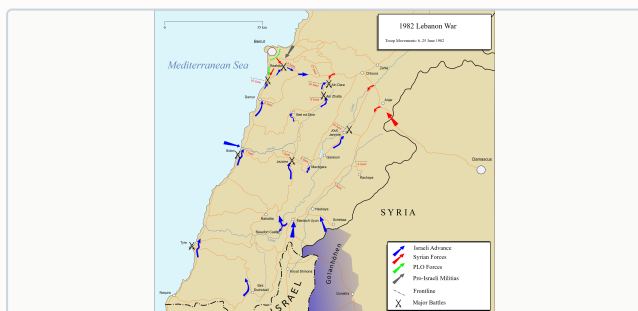
[3.3] On 3 June 1982, Palestinian terrorists from the dissident Abu Nidal group critically wounded Israeli ambassador Shlomo Argov in London. Although Abu Nidal was a bitter rival of Arafat, Israeli Defence Minister **Ariel Sharon** and Prime Minister Begin used the shooting as a pretext for a full-scale invasion. On 6 June 1982, Israel launched **Operation Peace for Galilee**.

[3.4] While the Israeli cabinet was told the advance would extend only 40 kilometers to push PLO artillery out of range, Sharon had secretly planned to push all the way to Beirut, link up with Christian Phalangist allies, and install a pro-Israeli government. In Operation Mole Cricket 19, the Israeli Air Force destroyed Syria's Soviet-supplied anti-aircraft missile batteries in the Bekaa Valley and shot down 82 Syrian MiGs. By mid-June, Israeli forces encircled West Beirut, subjecting the city to ten weeks of devastating aerial and naval bombardment. In August 1982, US special envoy Philip Habib brokered an agreement: over 14,000 PLO fighters evacuated Beirut by sea, with Arafat establishing a new exile headquarters in distant **Tunis**.

SOURCE A MILITARY CAMPAIGN MAP

June 1982

Operation Peace for Galilee: Israeli Advance to Beirut



IDF armored columns bypassed UNIFIL lines, pushing 40 kilometers north and laying siege to West Beirut to destroy the PLO infrastructure and force its evacuation.

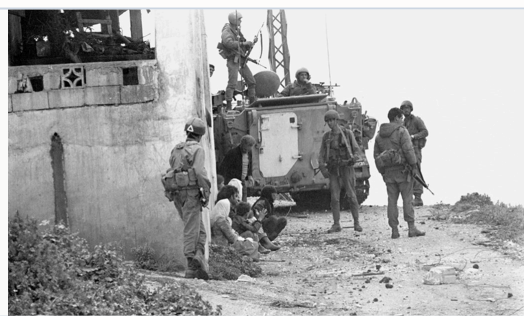
IDF Operations Branch

Lebanon Campaign Record, June 1982

SOURCE B ARCHIVAL PHOTOGRAPH

March 1978

Israeli Troops & Armoured Carrier in Southern Lebanon (Operation Litani)



IDF infantry and M113 armored vehicles patrol southern Lebanese villages during Operation Litani, launched in retaliation for the Coastal Road bus massacre to push PLO fedayeen north of the Litani River.

IDF Historical Archives

Southern Lebanon Operations, March 1978

KEY SPECIFICATION TERMINOLOGY & CONCEPTS

DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

Peace for Galilee:

1982 Israeli invasion of Lebanon to push PLO artillery 40km away, escalating into a full siege of Beirut and PLO evacuation.

Phalangist Militias:

Lebanese Christian Maronite militia responsible for the massacre of Palestinian civilians in Sabra and Shatila refugee camps.

Kahan Commission:

Independent Israeli judicial inquiry (1983) ruling Defence Minister Ariel Sharon bore personal responsibility for the massacres.

The Sabra & Shatila Massacres (September 1982)

The Beirut Disaster & The Rise of Hezbollah

[3.5] On 14 September 1982, Lebanon's newly elected Christian President, **Bachir Gemayel**—Israel's key ally—was assassinated in a massive bomb blast at Phalangist headquarters. The following morning, claiming that 2,000 PLO terrorists remained hidden in the refugee camps, Sharon ordered Israeli forces to occupy West Beirut and authorize Lebanese Christian Phalangist militiamen to enter the Palestinian refugee camps of **Sabra and Shatila** to 'mop up' fighters.

[3.6] What followed was a horrific atrocity. For 36 hours between 16 and 18 September, Phalangist militiamen systematically butchered defenseless civilians while Israeli flares illuminated the night sky above the camps and Israeli sentries guarded camp exits. Between 800 and 2,000 Palestinian and Lebanese civilians—overwhelmingly women, children, and elderly men—were massacred with axes, knives, and machine guns.

The Kahan Commission & Israeli Domestic Outrage

[3.7] The horror of the massacres shattered Israel's moral self-image and triggered a massive domestic political convulsion. On 25 September 1982, an unprecedented 400,000 Israelis—nearly 10% of the entire national population—rallied in Tel Aviv's Kings of Israel Square, demanding an independent judicial inquiry and Sharon's resignation.

[3.8] In February 1983, the official **Kahan Commission** published its findings. It exonerated the IDF of direct guilt, concluding that Phalangists had perpetrated the killings. However, the commission found Defence Minister Ariel Sharon guilty of *"indirect responsibility"* and serious negligence for ignoring the obvious danger of bloodshed when ordering bloodthirsty Phalangists into the camps. Sharon was forced to resign as Defence Minister, while Prime Minister Menachem Begin resigned in August 1983, broken by the quagmire.

SOURCE C

OFFICIAL JUDICIAL VERDICT

7 February 1983

Final Findings of the Official Kahan Commission of Inquiry

"It is in our view impossible to justify the Minister of Defence's disregard of the danger of a massacre... If the Minister of Defence decided that Phalangists should enter the camps, it was his duty to consider the grave danger that the Phalangists would perpetrate acts of slaughter and vengeance against the Palestinians... The Minister of Defence bears personal responsibility."

State of Israel Judicial Archives

Jerusalem, 7 February 1983

[3.9] The Lebanon War produced disastrous long-term blowback for Israeli security. In 1982–83, Iranian Revolutionary Guards mobilized Lebanon's marginalized Shia population to create **Hezbollah** ('Party of God'). Committed to driving Western and Israeli forces out through suicide bombings, Hezbollah unleashed devastating attacks: on 23 October 1983, coordinated suicide truck bombings in Beirut destroyed the US Marine barracks (killing 241 Americans) and French paratrooper headquarters (killing 58 French soldiers), compelling Western peacekeepers to evacuate. By 1985, Israel pulled back to a narrow southern 'Security Zone,' where IDF soldiers remained trapped in a fifteen-year war of attrition until May 2000.

CONCEPT SPOTLIGHT

DOMESTIC CRISIS • SEPT 1982

Kings of Israel Square: 400,000 Protest Beirut

On 25 September 1982, 400,000 Israelis (nearly 10% of the nation) rallied in Tel Aviv demanding Sharon's dismissal. It was the largest demonstration in Israeli history and exposed profound domestic moral rupture.

Key Significance: Shattered wartime consensus and forced appointment of the Kahan Commission.

KEY FIGURE

1928–2014



Ariel Sharon

ISRAELI DEFENCE MINISTER (1981–1983)

Aggressive military commander who orchestrated the 1982 Lebanon invasion and was found indirectly responsible for Sabra-Shatila.

STRATEGIC DECISIONS & ACTIONS:

- Operation Peace for Galilee:** Pushed IDF 60 miles to Beirut to destroy PLO infrastructure.
- Forced Resignation:** Dismissed in 1983 following the scathing judicial verdict of the Kahan Commission.

ARCHIVAL DISPATCH

WHITE HOUSE TELEPHONE RECORD

12 August 1982

President Ronald Reagan's Ultimatum to PM Menachem Begin

"Menachem, this has got to stop! The symbol of this war is becoming a picture of a seven-month-old baby with its arms blown off. This endless barrage is destroying any chance of peace and destroying Israel's standing in America."

White House Situation Room Declassified Memorandum

Washington, 12 Aug 1982

KEY TOPIC 3.4 GRASSROOTS UPRISING • 1987–1992

The First Intifada & Shifting Superpower Alliances

Pearson Specification Focus: Causes and outbreak of the First Intifada (December 1987); the roles of the UNLU and Hamas; Yitzhak Rabin's 'Iron Fist' policy; international media impact; Arafat's 1988 Geneva renunciation of terrorism; the collapse of the Soviet Union; and the 1991 Madrid Conference.

The Spark at Jabalia & Outbreak of the Intifada

[4.1] By December 1987, Palestinian frustration had reached boiling point. For twenty years since 1967, 1.5 million Palestinians in the West Bank and Gaza had lived under military occupation, facing curfews, land confiscations, home demolitions, and arbitrary checkpoints. Simultaneously, Israeli right-wing governments had built over 100 Jewish settlements, settling 70,000 Israelis in the occupied territories.

[4.2] On 8 December 1987, an IDF tank transporter collided with civilian cars at the Erez checkpoint in Gaza, killing four Palestinian labourers from the **Jabalia refugee camp**. Believing the crash was a deliberate act of revenge for an earlier stabbing, thousands of mourners turned the funerals into an angry riot. The spontaneous uprising spread like wildfire across Gaza and the West Bank, becoming known as the **First Intifada** (Arabic for 'shaking off').

UNLU, Hamas & Rabin's 'Iron Fist'

[4.3] Unlike earlier military conflicts, the Intifada was a civil, grassroots uprising directed not from Tunis, but by local underground committees united as the **Unified National Leadership of the Uprising (UNLU)**. The UNLU organized commercial general strikes, tax boycotts, barricades, and mass demonstrations. Crucially, the uprising saw the birth of **Hamas** (the Islamic Resistance Movement), founded by Sheikh Ahmed Yassin in Gaza, which rejected the secular PLO and advocated armed jihad to destroy Israel.

[4.4] Israeli Defence Minister **Yitzhak Rabin** responded with an uncompromising **'Iron Fist' policy**. Deploying thousands of troops, the IDF imposed prolonged curfews, rounded up 40,000 suspects into desert detention camps, closed Palestinian schools and universities, and ordered soldiers to "break the bones" of stone-throwers. However, nightly global television broadcasts showing teenage boys facing tanks shattered Israel's international image, causing profound moral distress inside Israeli society.

SOURCE AARCHIVAL PHOTOGRAPHDecember 1987

Palestinian Youths Confronting Israeli Armoured Vehicles

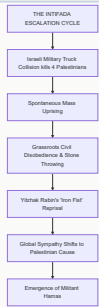


Television broadcasts showing unarmed Palestinian youths throwing stones against heavily armed Israeli soldiers transformed international public sympathy.

Reuters News AgencyGaza City, December 1987

SOURCE BANALYTICAL FLOWCHART1987–1993

The Intifada Escalation Cycle: From Erez to Madrid



The cycle of grassroots civil disobedience, Israeli military retaliation, and shifting international public opinion forced both Israeli and Palestinian leaders toward the negotiating table.

The History Revision Hub ArchivalMiddle East Peace Process Analysis

KEY SPECIFICATION TERMINOLOGY & CONCEPTS			DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY
The First Intifada: Spontaneous Palestinian popular uprising (1987) across Gaza and the West Bank using stone-throwing, commercial strikes, and boycotts.	The UNLU: Unified National Leadership of the Uprising; local grassroots committees directing strikes independently of the PLO in Tunis.	Geneva Declaration (1988): Historic speech in which Yasser Arafat renounced all terrorism and recognized the State of Israel under UN Resolution 242.	

Arafat's Geneva Concessions & US Dialogue (1988)

[4.5] The Intifada showed PLO Chairman Yasser Arafat that leadership of the Palestinian national cause was passing to the youth of Gaza and the West Bank. To retain political relevance, Arafat orchestrated a historic diplomatic pivot. In November 1988, the Palestine National Council in Algiers proclaimed the symbolic independence of Palestine on the 1967 borders, implicitly recognizing Israel.

[4.6] In December 1988, addressing a special UN session in Geneva, Arafat fulfilled three conditions demanded by Washington: he explicitly recognized **UN Security Council Resolutions 242 and 338**, accepted Israel's right to exist in peace and security, and totally renounced all forms of terrorism. In response, outgoing US President Ronald Reagan opened the first official diplomatic dialogue with the PLO, ending sixteen years of official American isolation.

SOURCE C ARCHIVAL PHOTOGRAPH

30 October 1991

The Opening Session of the Madrid Peace Conference



Co-sponsored by Presidents Bush and Gorbachev, the 1991 Madrid Conference brought Israel, Syria, Lebanon, and a Jordanian-Palestinian delegation face-to-face for the first time.

Palacio Real de Madrid Historical Record

Madrid, 30 October 1991

DIPLOMATIC CATALYST

THE MADRID FORMULA • OCT 1991

The Madrid Conference: Direct Talks Under Superpower Sponsorship

Convened by US President George H.W. Bush and Soviet President Mikhail Gorbachev, the 1991 Madrid Conference brought Israel, Syria, Lebanon, and a joint Jordanian-Palestinian delegation face-to-face for the first time in history. To bypass Israeli laws prohibiting official contact with the PLO, Palestinian delegates were officially presented as non-PLO West Bank residents. Although formal negotiations quickly stalled in public procedural disputes, Madrid shattered the psychological barrier against direct Israeli-Palestinian engagement and established the direct negotiating precedent that enabled the secret Oslo backchannel.

Strategic Turning Point: Normalized direct diplomacy and forced both Likud and PLO leadership to confront mutual political survival.

ARCHIVAL DISPATCH US CONGRESSIONAL RECORD 13 June 1990

Secretary of State James Baker's Challenge to the Parties

"Everybody over there says, 'Peace, peace, peace.' Well, here is the telephone number of the White House: 202-456-1414. When you are serious about peace, call us!"

US House Foreign Affairs Committee Testimony

Washington DC, June 1990

The Soviet Collapse, Gulf War & The 1991 Madrid Conference

[4.7] Between 1989 and 1991, the global Cold War framework collapsed. The fall of the Berlin Wall and the dissolution of the **Soviet Union** deprived radical Arab states (Syria, Iraq) of their superpower patron, military subsidies, and modern weapons shipments. Simultaneously, over 400,000 Soviet Jews emigrated to Israel between 1989 and 1992, providing a massive demographic influx of engineers, scientists, and military reservists that dramatically bolstered Israel's economic vitality and national security posture.

[4.8] In the 1991 Gulf War, a 34-nation US-led coalition crushed Saddam Hussein's Iraqi forces after Iraq fired 39 Scud missiles into Tel Aviv and Haifa in a failed attempt to fracture the coalition. Because Arafat made the disastrous strategic blunder of openly cheering Saddam's invasion of Kuwait, wealthy Gulf monarchies expelled 300,000 Palestinian expatriates and severed all financial subsidies to the PLO, leaving it diplomatically isolated and on the verge of bankruptcy. Exploiting this moment of undisputed American hegemony, US President George H.W. Bush and Secretary of State James Baker convened the **Madrid Peace Conference (October 1991)**, forcing Israeli Prime Minister Yitzhak Shamir and Arab delegations into direct face-to-face negotiations for the first time.

[4.9] The diplomatic landscape after Madrid presented both sides with inescapable realities. While Shamir's hardline Likud government attempted to drag out technical negotiations in Washington without yielding territory, the PLO faced complete extinction. Over 300,000 Palestinians were expelled from liberated Kuwait, and Palestinian tax revenues collapsed. Realizing that the Madrid talks were hopelessly deadlocked and that radical Islamist Hamas was eclipsing the secular PLO inside Gaza and the West Bank, Arafat recognized that only a direct, secret bilateral agreement with Israel could secure the PLO's survival.

KEY FIGURE

1929–2004



Yasser Arafat

CHAIRMAN OF THE PLO (1969–2004)

Leader who transformed the Palestinian national movement from guerilla armed struggle to international diplomacy, signing the 1993 Oslo Accords.

STRATEGIC DECISIONS & ACTIONS:

- **Renounced Terrorism in 1988:** Formally recognized Israel and accepted UN Resolution 242 in Geneva, opening formal diplomatic dialogue with the US.
- **Authorized Oslo Backchannel:** Negotiated the 1993 Oslo Declaration of Principles in secret, securing PLO recognition and return to Palestine.
- **Became First PA President:** Established the Palestinian National Authority in Gaza and Jericho in 1994, sharing the 1994 Nobel Peace Prize.

KEY TOPIC 3.5 OSLO & TRAGEDY • 1993–1995

The Oslo Accords, Oslo II & Rabin's Assassination

Pearson Specification Focus: Secret negotiations in Norway; the Oslo I Accords (1993) and Declaration of Principles; the 1994 Israel-Jordan Peace Treaty; Oslo II (1995) and the division of the West Bank into Areas A, B, and C; rising extremism and Hamas suicide bombings; and the assassination of Yitzhak Rabin (4 November 1995).

The Secret Norwegian Backchannel (1993)

[5.1] In June 1992, the Israeli Labour Party returned to power under Prime Minister **Yitzhak Rabin**, with **Shimon Peres** as Foreign Minister. Rabin campaigned on a pledge to achieve peace with the Palestinians within nine months. While official multilateral talks dragged endlessly in Washington, Norwegian sociologist Terje Rød-Larsen and Foreign Minister Johan Jørgen Holst established a secret backchannel in a secluded farmhouse outside Oslo.

[5.2] Away from media scrutiny, Israeli academics and PLO officials (led by Ahmed Qurei / Abu Ala) met for fourteen clandestine sessions. Both sides made historic concessions. Israel agreed to recognize the PLO as the official representative of the Palestinian people, while the PLO officially recognized the State of Israel's right to exist in peace and security and reiterated its rejection of terrorism.

The Oslo I Accords (1993) & The Jordan Treaty (1994)

[5.3] On 13 September 1993, on the South Lawn of the White House, Rabin and Arafat signed the **Declaration of Principles (Oslo I)**, sealed with a reluctant, historic handshake encouraged by President Bill Clinton. Oslo I established phased interim self-government: Israel would withdraw from the Gaza Strip and the West Bank town of Jericho (the 1994 Cairo Agreement), handing civil administration to the newly created **Palestinian National Authority (PA)** headed by Arafat.

[5.4] The momentum of Oslo spurred regional normalization. On 26 October 1994, Yitzhak Rabin and **King Hussein of Jordan** signed the **Israel-Jordan Peace Treaty** in the Arava Valley, formalizing borders, water-sharing arrangements, and recognizing Jordan's special historic custodianship over Muslim holy shrines in Jerusalem.

SOURCE A ARCHIVAL PHOTOGRAPH

13 September 1993

The Historic Handshake: Rabin, Clinton, and Arafat on the South Lawn



Prime Minister Yitzhak Rabin and PLO Chairman Yasser Arafat seal the Oslo I Declaration of Principles on the South Lawn of the White House, hosted by US President Bill Clinton.

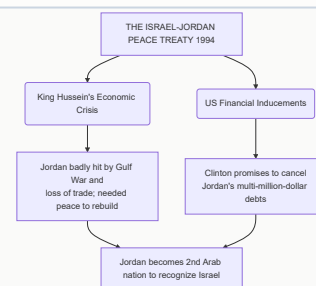
White House Press Office

Washington, D.C., 13 September 1993

SOURCE B HISTORICAL TREATY RECORD

26 October 1994

The Israel-Jordan Peace Treaty in the Arava Valley



Prime Minister Yitzhak Rabin and King Hussein of Jordan sign the historic bilateral peace treaty, ending forty-six years of belligerency and establishing normalized borders and water-sharing.

Hashemite Kingdom & Israeli Joint Archive

Arava Border Crossing, 26 October 1994

KEY SPECIFICATION TERMINOLOGY & CONCEPTS

Oslo Accord (1993):

Secret Norwegian backchannel breakthrough creating mutual PLO-Israeli recognition and phased Palestinian interim self-rule.

Areas A, B, and C:

Territorial division of the West Bank under Oslo II into Palestinian civil control (A & B) and exclusive Israeli military control (C).

Rabin Assassination:

Murder of Israeli Prime Minister Yitzhak Rabin on 4 November 1995 by Jewish extremist Yigal Amir, derailing peace implementation.

DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

Oslo II (1995) & The Division into Areas A, B, and C

[5.5] In September 1995, Rabin and Arafat signed the **Interim Agreement on the West Bank and Gaza Strip (Oslo II / Taba Accord)**. Oslo II extended Palestinian self-rule to major Palestinian cities, carving the West Bank into three administrative zones:

[5.6] • **Area A (3% of land, later 18%):** Included major Arab cities (Jenin, Nablus, Ramallah, Bethlehem, Hebron). Palestinian Authority held exclusive civil and security control.

• **Area B (24% of land):** Comprised 450 Palestinian villages. The PA administered civil services and policing, while Israel retained overriding military security.

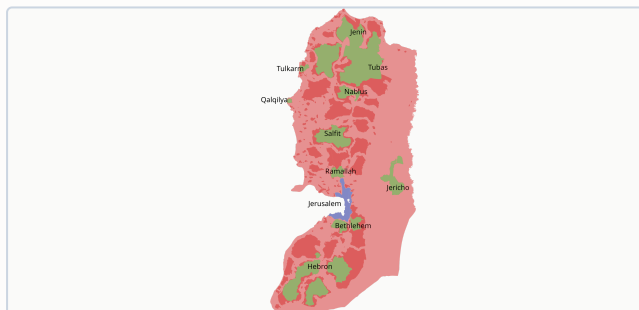
• **Area C (73% of land, later 60%):** Comprised all Jewish settlements, military bases, bypass roads, the Jordan Valley, and unpopulated state lands, remaining under total Israeli civil and military control.

[5.7] Crucially, Oslo II postponed the most explosive **'Final Status Issues'**—the permanent borders, the status of Jerusalem, Jewish settlements, and the right of return of Palestinian refugees—to future negotiations. This structural flaw allowed extremists on both sides to undermine the process.

SOURCE C HISTORICAL TREATY MAP

September 1995

The West Bank Divided: Oslo II Areas A, B, and C



Oslo II carved the West Bank into disconnected Palestinian enclaves (Area A: full PA control; Area B: joint civil-security control; Area C: total Israeli security and settlement jurisdiction).

Palestinian-Israeli Interim Agreement (Taba Accord)

September 1995

ARCHIVAL DISPATCH FINAL PEACE ADDRESS

4 Nov 1995

Yitzhak Rabin's Final Address at Kings of Israel Square

"I was a military man for 27 years. I waged war as long as there was no chance for peace. I believe there is now a chance for peace, a great chance, and we must seize it... Violence undermines the very foundation of Israeli democracy."

Final Address Before Assassination, Tel Aviv

4 November 1995

Rising Extremism, Assassination & The Derailement of Oslo (1994–1996)

[5.8] The peace process provoked violent backlash from extremists on both sides. In February 1994, Jewish extremist Baruch Goldstein massacred 29 Palestinian worshippers inside the Ibrahimi Mosque in Hebron. In retaliation, **Hamas and Palestinian Islamic Jihad** launched a deadly campaign of suicide bombings against Israeli civilian buses in Tel Aviv, Jerusalem, and Afula, killing dozens of civilians and destroying Israeli public confidence in peace.

[5.9] In Israel, right-wing opposition led by Likud's Benjamin Netanyahu fiercely attacked Rabin, with protest crowds chanting "Rabin is a traitor" and displaying posters of Rabin in Nazi SS uniform. On the evening of **4 November 1995**, Rabin addressed a massive peace rally of 100,000 supporters in Kings of Israel Square in Tel Aviv. As he walked to his car, **Yigal Amir**, a 25-year-old ultra-nationalist Jewish law student who believed giving up biblical land violated Jewish law, fired three hollow-point bullets into Rabin's back. Rabin died at Ichilov Hospital.

[5.10] Rabin's assassination dealt a fatal blow to the peace process. Following a wave of retaliatory Hamas bus bombings in early 1996 that killed 59 Israeli civilians, public faith in security evaporated. In May 1996, Likud's Benjamin Netanyahu narrowly defeated Shimon Peres on a hardline platform, slowing further troop redeployments and bringing the rapid momentum of the Oslo peace process to a permanent halt. In Rabin's jacket pocket, aides discovered a blood-soaked lyric sheet to 'Shir LaShalom' (Song of Peace), symbolizing the tragic snuffing out of the historic compromise.

KEY FIGURE

1922–1995



Yitzhak Rabin

PRIME MINISTER OF ISRAEL (1974–77, 1992–95)

Former IDF Chief of Staff who recognized the PLO, signed the Oslo Accords, and was assassinated by an Israeli extremist on 4 November 1995.

STRATEGIC DECISIONS & ACTIONS:

- **Authorized Secret Oslo Negotiations:** Recognized that military force could not suppress the Palestinian national movement, approving the backchannel talks in Norway.
- **Signed Oslo Accords & Jordan Treaty:** Exchanged mutual recognition with Arafat at the White House and signed the 1994 Israel-Jordan Peace Treaty with King Hussein.
- **Paid the Ultimate Sacrifice for Peace:** Stood firm against right-wing incitement until his assassination at a Tel Aviv peace rally on 4 November 1995.

KEY ENQUIRY CHECK • THE OSLO ACCORDS & LEGACY OF RABIN

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. OSLO PROVISIONS:

Explain how the division of the West Bank into Areas A, B, and C under Oslo II left Israel in control of 73% of the land.

2. OPPOSING EXTREMISM:

How did extremist violence from both Baruch Goldstein/Hamas and Yigal Amir deliberately sabotage the peace process?

3. EVALUATIVE HINGE:

Was the Oslo peace process doomed from the start due to deferred 'Final Status Issues', or did Rabin's murder kill the possibility of peace?

KEY TOPIC 3: CHRONOLOGY & DISCIPLINARY MASTERY (1974–1995)

Comprehensive revision index of peace diplomacy, military incursions, and Edexcel examination question frameworks.

KEY TOPIC 3 MASTER TIMELINE • CRITICAL CHRONOLOGICAL SEQUENCE

1974–1975	Kissinger's Shuttle Diplomacy	Sinai I and II disengagement accords signed; Egypt reopens the Suez Canal to commercial traffic in June 1975.
Nov 1974	Arafat Addresses the UN	Arafat delivers his famous 'olive branch and gun' speech; UN grants PLO permanent observer status.
May 1977	Menachem Begin Elected	Right-wing Likud Party wins Israeli elections, ending 29 years of uninterrupted Labour rule.
Nov 1977	Sadat Visits Jerusalem	Anwar Sadat addresses the Israeli Knesset in Jerusalem, proclaiming 'No more war' and breaking 30-year deadlock.
Sep 1978	Camp David Accords	Jimmy Carter brokers peace frameworks between Begin and Sadat after thirteen days of intense mediation.
26 Mar 1979	Treaty of Washington	Egypt-Israel Peace Treaty signed; Israel returns Sinai, but Egypt faces total diplomatic boycott by Arab states.
6 Oct 1981	Assassination of Sadat	Egyptian Islamic Jihad militants assassinate Anwar Sadat at a military parade in Cairo.
Jun 1982	Operation Peace for Galilee	Israel invades Lebanon; IDF besieges West Beirut and forces over 14,000 PLO fighters to evacuate to Tunisia.
Sep 1982	Sabra and Shatila Massacres	Phalangist militiamen butcher civilians in refugee camps; Kahan Commission finds Sharon indirectly responsible.
Dec 1987	First Intifada Erupts	Grassroots uprising begins in Gaza and West Bank; stone-throwers confront Rabin's 'Iron Fist' policy; Hamas founded.
13 Sep 1993	Oslo I Accords Signed	Rabin and Arafat shake hands on White House lawn; Palestinian Authority established for interim self-rule.
4 Nov 1995	Assassination of Rabin	Prime Minister Yitzhak Rabin assassinated by Jewish extremist Yigal Amir at a peace rally in Tel Aviv.

KEY DISCIPLINARY TERMINOLOGY

- **Shuttle Diplomacy:** Intensive bilateral mediation where an envoy travels between parties refusing direct talks.
- **Framework for Peace:** The 1978 Camp David accords outlining Egyptian peace and transitional Palestinian autonomy.
- **Operation Peace for Galilee:** Israeli invasion of Lebanon (1982) aiming to eliminate PLO rocket bases and armed enclaves.
- **First Intifada:** Grassroots Palestinian uprising (1987–1993) characterized by demonstrations, strikes, and stone-throwing.
- **UNLU:** Unified National Leadership of the Uprising; underground coalition directing Intifada resistance.
- **Areas A, B, and C:** Administrative zones created by Oslo II (1995) dividing West Bank civil and military control.

EDEXCEL PAPER 2 EXAM FRAMEWORK & MODELS**32 MARKS
TOTAL****Q1: Explain ONE consequence of... [4 Marks]***Model Question:* "Explain one consequence of Anwar Sadat's visit to Jerusalem in November 1977."*Formula:* Trigger → Direct diplomatic breakthrough → Leading to Camp David. (1 paragraph)**Q2: Write an analytical narrative explaining... [8 Marks]***Model Question:* "Write an analytical narrative explaining the collapse of the peace process between 1993 and 1995. You may use: (1) Hamas suicide bombings, (2) Rabin's assassination."*Formula:* 3 chronological stages linked with causal connectives ('Consequently', 'As a direct result').**Q3: Explain the importance of... for... [8 Marks]***Model Question:* "Explain the importance of the Sabra and Shatila massacres (1982) for Israeli domestic politics."*Formula:* 2 PEEL paragraphs explaining 'What difference did X make to Y?'**INTERACTIVE DIGITAL RETRIEVAL HUB KEY TOPIC 3 KNOWLEDGE QUIZ & FLASHCARDS**

Scan the QR code with any smartphone or tablet camera to launch the interactive, self-marking retrieval bank for Key Topic 3. Test your rapid recall across Shuttle Diplomacy, Camp David, Lebanon (1982), Sabra and Shatila, First Intifada, Oslo Accords, and Rabin's assassination with instant model answers and scoring.

- 20 Specification Recall Questions
- Instant Self-Marking & Explanations
- Digital Leitner Flashcard Deck



SCAN FOR MOBILE QUIZ